RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

16 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 6:53 PM, Friday 16 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 152 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Halted** · 60 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 7,050 minutes at 7:00 PM; Dammam halted since 5:44 PM, 75 minutes

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 7,050 minutes at 7:00 PM; NOTAM A3604/26 keeps it closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 152 flights cancelled so far for Friday (33% of scheduled).
- Dammam halted since 5:44 PM, 75 minutes; no takeoff or landing in the last hour (last landing flynas XY420 from Jeddah at 5:44 PM; last takeoff PIA PK246 to Islamabad at 5:25 PM).
- 60 Dammam flights cancelled today (26%).
- Coalition: ballistic missile toward Yanbu, two Red Sea cruise missiles, and three UAVs (south + Riyadh) intercepted and destroyed (SPA, 5:14 PM).

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (7044 min).

152	0/0	4
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

HALTED

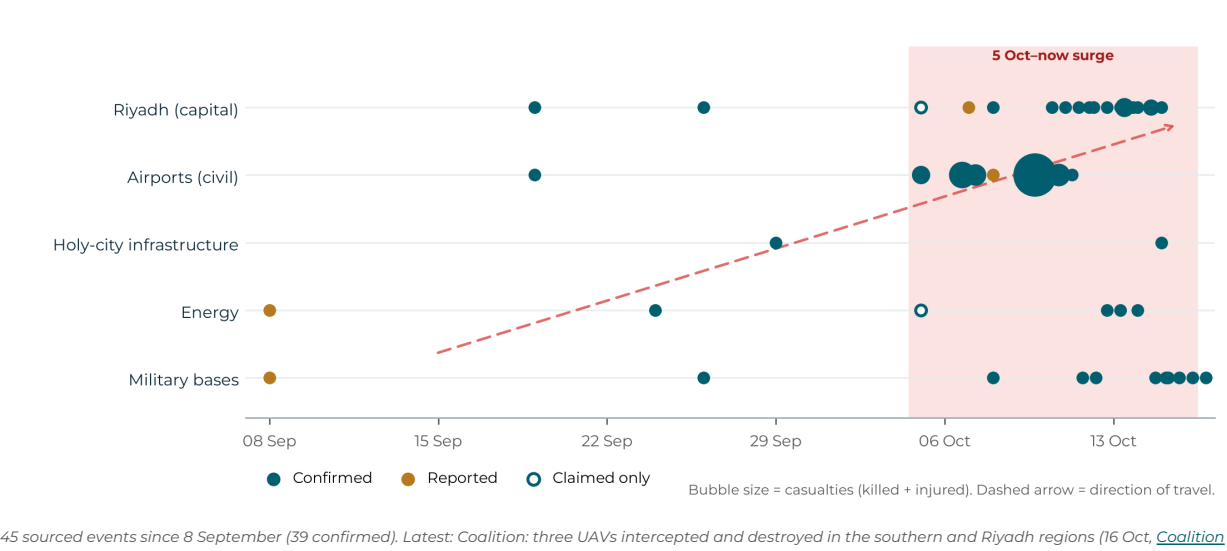
No takeoff or landing since 5:44 PM (69 min).

60	0/0	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday (6,751 min at 2:00 PM)
- Dammam 3 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour, latest PK726 takeoff at 1:36 PM
- Unconfirmed social claims of explosions over Dammam at 1:25 PM; no Civil Defense alert
- Air India and Air India Express reportedly extend Saudi suspensions to 20 Oct

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 16 OCT



45 sourced events since 8 September (39 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: three UAVs intercepted and destroyed in the southern and Riyadh regions (16 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 6:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED ATTACK **6:05 PM AST · King Khalid University digital media professor: verify official sources and check circulating attack videos for AI fakes to fight rumors**

verify official sources and check circulating attack videos for AI fakes to fight rumors: King Khalid University digital media professor: verify official sources and check circulating attack videos for AI fakes to fight rumors. Al Ekhbariya

Last 24 hours: Attacks 2, interceptions 5, alerts 2, all-clears 2.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

3 Riyadh still halted; GCC welcomes UN Security Council stance; no new alert since Yanbu

Checked at 7:00 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **King Khalid University digital media professor: verify official sources and check circulating attack videos for AI fakes to fight rumors**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **6:05 PM** · published 6:05 PM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account); checked 7:00 PM; translated from Arabic

Dr. Issa Al-Mustaneer, digital media professor at King Khalid University: verifying official sources and scrutinizing circulating videos about the attacks to detect AI deepfakes are among the main ways to fight rumors and misleading information.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Al-Khafji residents show national solidarity and steadfast loyalty to the leadership**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **6:18 PM** · published 6:18 PM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account); checked 7:00 PM; translated from Arabic

Feelings of pride and belonging appear in the positions of Al-Khafji residents — national solidarity and steadfast loyalty to the leadership.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: ballistic missile toward Yanbu, two cruise missiles over the Red Sea, and three UAVs in the southern and Riyadh regions intercepted and destroyed**

SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **5:14 PM** · published 5:14 PM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account); checked 5:55 PM

Coalition: Ballistic missile launched toward Yanbu intercepted and destroyed in recent hours. Two cruise missiles intercepted and destroyed over the Red Sea. Three UAVs intercepted and destroyed in the southern and Riyadh regions.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Foreign Ministry welcomes the UN Security Council presidential statement on Houthi attacks against the Kingdom**

Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) · **5:39 PM** · published 5:39 PM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account); checked 5:55 PM

The Foreign Ministry expresses Saudi Arabia's welcome for the presidential statement issued by the members of the UN Security Council. (Follows earlier SPA/GCC welcomes of the same UNSC stance.)

CONFIRMED **Saudi embassy in Kuwait helps 90 stranded Saudi citizens return home**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:45 PM** · published 5:45 PM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 7:00 PM

From Kuwait to the homeland: Saudi efforts to facilitate the return of 90 stranded citizens and provide for their comfort, per the Saudi ambassador to Kuwait.

CONFIRMED **GCC Secretary-General welcomes the UN Security Council's position on Houthi aggression against the Kingdom**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **4:47 PM** · published 4:47 PM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 4:53 PM

The Secretary-General of the Gulf Cooperation Council welcomed the UN Security Council's stance on Houthi aggression against Saudi Arabia. This follows Saudi Arabia's own welcome of the Security Council presidential statement earlier today.

UNVERIFIED **India again advises its nationals in Saudi Arabia to follow local authorities and stay indoors during any aerial attack**

Orissa Post (@OrissaPOSTLive) · **3:45 PM** · posted 3:45 PM AST Fri 16 Oct (media report of an Indian embassy advisory); checked 3:55 PM

Orissa Post reports that India on Friday again told its nationals in Saudi Arabia to keep following local authorities' instructions and to stay indoors in case of an aerial attack, as flight disruptions continue after the Riyadh airport attack. The embassy advisory itself was not checked directly.

CONFIRMED **Makkah and Madinah Friday sermons condemn the Houthi attack on King Khalid airport in Riyadh as a flagrant atrocity**

SPA (@Spa_Eng), Al Ekhbariya · **3:31 PM** · Al Ekhbariya 12:52 PM; SPA English summaries 3:31 PM (Makkah) and 3:32 PM (Madinah) AST Fri 16 Oct; checked 3:55 PM

Grand Mosque preacher Sheikh Abdullah Al-Juhani called the Houthi targeting of King Khalid International Airport and attacks on travelers, pilgrims and civilians a heinous crime and a cowardly terrorist act. Prophet's Mosque preacher Sheikh Ahmed Al-Hudhaifi condemned the targeting of Makkah, Madinah and the Riyadh airport. SPA's English service later summarised the Makkah sermon as condemning the 'terrorist Houthi attack on Riyadh Airport' and the Madinah sermon as calling attacks on holy sites and Riyadh airport 'flagrant atrocities'.

UNVERIFIED **OSINT account claims explosions over Dammam and a brief suspension at King Fahd airport; no official alert or confirmation**

War Tracker X (@WarTrackerX) · **1:25 PM** · posted 1:25 PM AST Fri 16 Oct (unofficial account); checked 2:55 PM

An OSINT account claimed explosions were heard across Dammam during a missile attack and that King Fahd International Airport briefly suspended flights. Civil Defense issued no alert for the Eastern Province in this period, and the Dammam board shows no gap longer than 24 minutes (landings at 1:02 and 1:07 PM, takeoffs at 1:31 and 1:36 PM). Treat as unconfirmed.

UNVERIFIED **Air India and Air India Express extend their Saudi flight suspensions (Riyadh, Dammam, Jeddah) until 20 October**

NewsMobile India (@NewsMobileIndia); State Sentinel · **12:55 PM** · media reports posted 12:55 PM and 1:30 PM AST Fri 16 Oct; airline statement not seen directly; checked 2:55 PM

Indian media report that Air India and Air India Express have extended the suspension of their flights to and from Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah until 20 October because of the security situation.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Arabia welcomes the UN Security Council presidential statement condemning Houthi attacks on the Kingdom, including on airports and energy infrastructure**

SPA (@SPAregions), Foreign Ministry statement · **12:44 PM** · published 12:44 PM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 2:55 PM

The Foreign Ministry welcomed the Security Council members' presidential statement, which condemned the continuing and escalating Houthi attacks on the Kingdom, including attacks on civilian objects, airports and energy infrastructure, and the threats that accompany them.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense issues an early-warning alert for Yanbu Governorate, then declares the danger passed eight minutes later**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD); Al Ekhbariya · **12:47 PM** · alert posted 12:39 PM, all-clear 12:47 PM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, Arabic/English); checked 2:55 PM

The National Early Warning Platform issued an alert for Yanbu Governorate at 12:39 PM warning of a potential danger. At 12:47 PM Civil Defense said the danger had passed and told residents to avoid gathering and filming, repeating that sharing intercept or impact-site information is a legal liability. No official word on an intercept, impact or damage.

UNVERIFIED **Social posts claim explosions near Yanbu port during the alert; Houthi-aligned accounts claim a strike**

Live AIS (@live_ais_com); other social accounts · **12:45 PM** · posts from ~12:43–12:54 PM AST Fri 16 Oct; no official confirmation of any impact; checked 2:55 PM

Several social and OSINT accounts reported explosions heard near Yanbu port while the alert was active, and pro-Houthi accounts claimed the city was hit. Saudi authorities have only confirmed the alert and the all-clear; there is no official report of an intercept, damage or casualties.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Arabia and Arab and Islamic nations condemn Colombia's opening of an embassy in Jerusalem**

Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) · **1:31 PM** · published 1:31 PM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, English); checked 2:55 PM

The Foreign Ministry said Saudi Arabia joined Arab and Islamic nations in condemning and rejecting Colombia's opening of an embassy in Jerusalem. Not related to the Houthi attacks or the airports.

CONFIRMED **Minister of State Adel Al-Jubeir receives the ambassadors of Finland, Ireland and Denmark in Riyadh**

Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) · **11:32 AM** · posted 11:31–11:32 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, three posts merged); checked 2:55 PM

The Foreign Ministry said Minister of State for Foreign Affairs Adel Al-Jubeir received the ambassadors of Finland, Ireland and Denmark in Riyadh and discussed issues of mutual interest. The posts did not mention the Houthi attacks or the airport.

CONFIRMED **Pakistan PM Shehbaz Sharif condemns Houthi attacks on the Kingdom while meeting the new Saudi ambassador**

PTV Global (@PakTVGlobal) · **11:24 AM** · posted 11:24 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (Pakistan state broadcaster); checked 2:55 PM

Pakistan's state broadcaster said Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, meeting newly appointed Saudi Ambassador Rajeh Tami Albugamy, condemned the Houthi attacks on the Kingdom and reaffirmed Pakistan's commitment to Saudi sovereignty and territorial integrity.

CONFIRMED **King Khalid International Airport tells travelers to follow official authorities on the airspace and contact their airline; no reopening announced**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **12:19 PM** · latest reply posted 12:19 PM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, to a traveler; same wording as its 11:03 AM reply); checked 2:55 PM

Asked by a traveler for an update, the airport's official account replied that people should follow the relevant official authorities for airspace updates and contact the airline they booked with. It gave no reopening time; NOTAM A3604/26 still keeps the airport closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct.

UNVERIFIED **Air India Express also suspends flights to several Saudi destinations until 20 October**

Orissa POST (@OrissaPOSTLive) · **10:55 AM** · posted 10:55 AM AST Fri 16 Oct; Air India Express advisory not checked directly; checked 2:55 PM

Orissa POST reported that Air India and Air India Express on Friday announced the suspension of flights to several destinations in Saudi Arabia until 20 October, citing the evolving security situation. Air India's own advisory (Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah) is already confirmed above.

CONFIRMED **Air India: all flights to and from Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah cancelled until 20 October 2026**

Air India (@airindia) · **8:41 AM** · published 8:41 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (official airline advisory); checked 2:55 PM

Air India said that in view of the evolving situation in Saudi Arabia, all of its flights to and from Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah stand cancelled until 20 October 2026, and that it is monitoring developments for a safe resumption.

CONFIRMED **Philippine News Agency: Manila preparing to repatriate about 200 OFWs stranded by Saudi flight cancellations**

Philippine News Agency (@pnagovph) · **9:35 AM** · posted 9:35 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (official PH agency); checked 9:55 AM

The Philippine News Agency reported that the government is preparing to bring home around 200 overseas Filipino workers stranded by flight cancellations after missile and drone attacks in Saudi Arabia.

UNVERIFIED DMM **Social posts claim explosions in Dammam and a fresh halt at King Fahd airport**

Raaz News; other social accounts · **9:46 AM** · posts from ~9:39–9:46 AM AST Fri 16 Oct; no official GACA, KFIA or SPA confirmation; checked 9:55 AM

Several social accounts posted that explosions hit Dammam and that flights halted at King Fahd International Airport. No official Saudi account has confirmed a new Dammam attack or closure this morning; the live board earlier showed Dammam still moving.

UNVERIFIED **Saudi Asian Cup organisers say the January 2027 tournament is on schedule despite the Houthi attacks**

Deccan Chronicle (@DeccanChronicle) · **7:54 AM** · posted 7:54 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (media report, no official statement checked directly); checked 9:55 AM

Deccan Chronicle reported that Saudi organisers said the 2027 AFC Asian Cup, due to start on 7 January in Saudi Arabia, remains on schedule amid growing concern after the Houthi attacks.

UNVERIFIED DMM **Sprinter Press posts that air traffic is suspended at Dammam airport**

Sprinter Press (@SprinterPress) · **7:40 AM** · posted 7:40 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (single social post, no official confirmation); the Flightradar24 board shows Air Arabia 4P1 taking off for Jeddah at 7:52 AM; checked 9:55 AM

A single post by Sprinter Press said air traffic was suspended at Dammam airport. No official source has confirmed it, King Fahd International Airport has not posted about a suspension, and the live board shows Air Arabia 4P1 taking off for Jeddah at 7:52 AM.

CONFIRMED **King Khalid International Airport: baggage can be collected from the airline's baggage office once operations resume**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **6:49 AM** · published 6:49 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, Arabic reply to a traveler, translated); checked 9:55 AM

Replying to a traveler whose bag is still at the airport, KKIA said that when operations resume, passengers can go to their airline's baggage services office in the arrivals area, and asked travelers to follow the official authorities and contact the airline they booked with. The reply confirms operations have not resumed.

CORROBORATED **India's ambassador: Riyadh airport is closed and Air India and IndiGo flights are cancelled; 24/7 helplines set up**

United News of India; ET Now · **6:35 AM** · UNI post 6:35 AM AST, ET Now 5:54 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (video message by Ambassador Vipul); checked 9:55 AM

In a video message to Indians in Saudi Arabia, Ambassador Vipul said Riyadh airport is closed and flights by Indian airlines such as Air India and IndiGo have been cancelled. The embassy has set up 24/7 helplines for affected citizens and Umrah pilgrims.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Yemeni armed forces target Houthi field commanders, reinforcements and military sites**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **6:12 AM** · published 6:12 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 9:55 AM

Saudi state TV reported that Yemen's armed forces struck field commanders, reinforcements, equipment and military positions belonging to the Houthi militia.

CONFIRMED **KSrelief distributes about 13,000 liters of water in Yemen's Taiz governorate**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **6:07 AM** · published 6:07 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 9:55 AM

Al Ekhbariya said the King Salman Humanitarian Aid and Relief Centre distributed about 13,000 liters of water in Taiz, Yemen.

CONFIRMED **Coalition intercepts and destroys a drone launched toward the Eastern Province**

Coalition Joint Forces Command (@CJFCSpox); SPA (@SPAregions); Al Ekhbariya · **5:39 AM** · published 5:39–5:43 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (official accounts, Arabic, translated); also carried by SPA (Arabic 5:43 AM, English 6:48 AM) and Al Ekhbariya (5:41 AM, repeated 6:05 AM); the Coalition spokesman has posted only one such statement since; checked 9:55 AM

Coalition Joint Forces Command: intercepted and destroyed a drone launched toward the Eastern Province. Relayed by SPA (@SPAregions) and Al Ekhbariya. No impact or casualties reported.

CONFIRMED **National Center for Meteorology: moderate to heavy thunderstorms with flash floods, hail and strong winds forecast in the southwest and north; light to moderate rain in the Eastern Province**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **7:00 AM** · published 7:00 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 9:55 AM

SPA carried the weather forecast: moderate to heavy thunderstorms causing flash floods, with hail and strong winds, over Jazan, Asir, Al Baha, Makkah, Hail, Al Jouf and the Northern Borders, and light to moderate rain over Madinah, Tabuk and the Eastern Province, with fog on coastal areas.

UNVERIFIED **US Embassy: US government staff need special authorization to use any Saudi airport; Jeddah and Dammam airports remain operational**

Iran International · **2:40 AM** · article 2:40 AM AST Fri 16 Oct, citing a US Embassy Riyadh security alert posted Thursday; embassy X post not checked directly; checked 9:55 AM

Iran International reported that the US Embassy in Riyadh said US government employees now need special authorization to use any airport in the Kingdom, and that GACA had extended the King Khalid airport suspension through 17 October. The alert said King Abdulaziz (Jeddah) and King Fahd (Dammam) airports remained operational with some delays and cancellations.

UNVERIFIED **IndiGo reported to cancel flights to and from Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam and Madinah until 24 October**

India.com (@indiacom) · **7:11 AM** · posted 7:11 AM AST Fri 16 Oct; IndiGo advisory not checked directly; checked 7:57 AM

India.com reported that IndiGo has cancelled its flights to and from Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam and Madinah until 24 October because of the security situation, and that Akasa Air extended its Riyadh suspension.

CONFIRMED **Vice Foreign Minister Waleed Elkhereiji tells European and African ambassadors that Houthi terrorist attacks on the Kingdom are war crimes**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **4:15 AM** · published 4:15 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 4:52 AM

State TV reported that Vice Foreign Minister Waleed Elkhereiji held a meeting with ambassadors of European and African countries accredited to the Kingdom and affirmed that the Houthi terrorist attacks on Saudi Arabia constitute war crimes.

UNVERIFIED **Canada advises citizens to avoid King Khalid International Airport and non-essential travel to other Saudi airports**

Middle East Eye (citing Canadian embassy advisory) · **2:11 AM** · reported 16 Oct 2026 ~00:11 BST / ~2:11 AM AST; Canadian embassy X post not checked directly; checked 4:52 AM

Middle East Eye reported that the Canadian embassy in Saudi Arabia advised citizens to avoid all travel to King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh and non-essential travel to other Saudi airports after recent missile and drone attacks, noting Riyadh's main airport remained closed.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya condemns the Houthi militia, saying its repeated assaults on holy sites, pilgrims and civilians expose its false claims to defend Islam**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **3:30 AM** · published 3:30 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 3:58 AM

State TV said the 'terrorist Houthi militia' chants slogans and claims to champion Islam, while its repeated terrorist attacks expose the falseness of those claims and a hostile approach that targets holy sites, their visitors and innocent civilians.

UNVERIFIED **Cargo Facts: Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport remains closed after the deadly missile strikes**

Cargo Facts (@CargoFacts) · **3:00 AM** · posted 3:00 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (trade publication); consistent with the live board and NOTAM A3604/26; checked 3:58 AM

Air-cargo trade outlet Cargo Facts reported that King Khalid International Airport remains closed following the deadly missile strikes on the airport. The live Flightradar24 board shows no Riyadh movements this hour.

UNVERIFIED **US State Department reported to raise Saudi Arabia to Level 3 'Reconsider Travel', citing missile attacks**

MD Bay News (@MDBayNews) · **2:56 AM** · posted 2:56 AM AST Fri 16 Oct; State Department advisory page not checked directly; checked 3:58 AM

A news account reported that the State Department issued a Level 3 'Reconsider Travel' advisory for Saudi Arabia, citing missile attacks along with arrests and exit bans. The advisory itself has not been checked directly.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: infographic on casualties from Houthi attacks on King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **2:18 AM** · published 2:18 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 2:59 AM

Al Ekhbariya published an infographic on casualties and injuries from Houthi militia attacks on King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: infographic on casualties from Houthi attacks on Abha International Airport**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **2:20 AM** · published 2:20 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 2:59 AM

Al Ekhbariya published an infographic on casualties and injuries from Houthi militia attacks on Abha International Airport.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: infographic on injuries from Houthi attacks on King Abdullah International Airport in Jazan**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **2:26 AM** · published 2:26 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 2:59 AM

Al Ekhbariya published an infographic on injuries from Houthi militia attacks on King Abdullah International Airport in Jazan.

CONFIRMED **Saudi MOFA: Riyadh | Vice Minister of Foreign Affairs H.E. @W_Elkhereiji holds a meeting with ambassadors of European and African countries accredited to the King**

Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) · **2:14 AM** · published 2:14 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account); checked 2:56 AM

#Riyadh | Vice Minister of Foreign Affairs H.E. @W_Elkhereiji holds a meeting with ambassadors of European and African countries accredited to the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Vice Foreign Minister Waleed Elkhereiji receives Syrian Foreign Minister Asaad al-Shaibani in Riyadh to discuss bilateral ties and regional developments**

Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) · **1:00 AM** · published 1:00 AM AST Fri 16 Oct (official account); checked 1:58 AM

#Riyadh | Vice Minister of Foreign Affairs H.E. @W_Elkhereiji received Syrian Foreign Minister @AsaadHShaibani upon his arrival in Riyadh.

CONFIRMED **King Khalid International Airport tells travelers to follow official authorities for airspace updates and contact their airline**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **11:39 PM** · published 11:39 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, reply to a traveler); checked 11:58 PM

Replying to a traveler, the airport's official account said that for the latest airspace updates people should follow the competent official authorities and contact the airline they booked with. It gave no reopening time.

CONFIRMED **UN Security Council condemns the Houthi escalation against the Kingdom and affirms its right to self-defense**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **11:34 PM** · SPA published 11:34 PM AST Thu 15 Oct; Al Ekhbariya follow-up 12:05 AM Fri 16 Oct (https://x.com/alekhbariyatv/status/2110839596539879878); checked 12:58 AM

SPA reported that UN Security Council members condemned the Houthi attacks on the Kingdom in the strongest terms. Al Ekhbariya added at 12:05 AM that the Council affirmed Saudi Arabia's right to self-defense.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya tallies Houthi attacks on the Kingdom since March 2016: 1,104 ballistic missiles and 1,135 drones**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **11:09 PM** · published 11:09 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (state TV infographic); checked 11:58 PM

A state TV infographic counts Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia from 26 March 2016 to 15 October 2026 at 1,104 ballistic missiles, 1,135 drones, 118 explosive boats and 278 naval mines.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense issues early-warning alert for Jizan, then declares the danger over three minutes later**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv), relaying Saudi Civil Defense · **10:37 PM** · published 10:37 PM and 10:40 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 10:48 PM

Al Ekhbariya, citing Civil Defense, reported an early-warning alert in Jizan at 10:37 PM and the all-clear at 10:40 PM. No interception, debris or casualties were reported. At 10:41 PM Civil Defense repeated that filming or sharing intercept or impact-site information is a legal liability.

UNVERIFIED **Khaleej Times: more than 4,000 flights cancelled in a week across Saudi Arabia as Riyadh airport stays shut**

Khaleej Times · **7:26 PM** · published 7:26 PM AST Thu 15 Oct; checked 10:52 PM

Khaleej Times reports more than 4,000 flights cancelled in a week as King Khalid International Airport remains closed. The count is the outlet's own and has not been confirmed by GACA.

CONFIRMED **Coalition spokesman releases footage of a drone being intercepted**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **9:53 PM** · published 9:53 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 9:58 PM

SPA posted footage from the coalition spokesman showing a drone interception. The post gives no location or time, so it is not counted as a new interception.

CONFIRMED **Coalition spokesman releases footage of a cruise missile being intercepted and destroyed**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **9:41 PM** · published 9:41 PM AST Thu 15 Oct, first posted 9:26 PM (official account); checked 9:58 PM

SPA posted two clips from the coalition spokesman showing a cruise missile being intercepted and destroyed. Neither post gives a location or time, so it is not counted as a new interception.

CONFIRMED **Coalition says regional parties helped the Houthi militia with advanced technology**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **9:37 PM** · published 9:37 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 9:58 PM

Al Ekhbariya, relaying the coalition, said regional parties helped the Houthi militia with advanced technologies. The parties were not named in the post.

CONFIRMED **Kenya's foreign minister calls Saudi deputy foreign minister to condemn Houthi attacks on the Kingdom**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **9:08 PM** · published 9:08 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 9:58 PM

Kenya's foreign minister condemned the Houthi militia's attacks on the Kingdom, civilian sites and vital facilities, and expressed solidarity with Saudi Arabia, SPA said.

CONFIRMED **Coalition publishes video of Houthi attacks on Abha, Najran and Jizan airports shown at today's press conference**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **8:53 PM** · published 8:53 PM AST Thu 15 Oct; SPA reposted at 9:00 and 9:01 PM; checked 9:58 PM

The coalition spokesman released video, shown at today's press conference, of earlier Houthi attacks on Abha International, Najran International and King Abdullah International (Jizan) airports. This is footage of past attacks, not a new strike.

CONFIRMED **Coalition spokesman at KKIA-attack press conference: targeting civilian airports is a flagrant violation of international humanitarian law; coalition will keep dismantling Houthi offensive capabilities**

SPA (@SPAregions) / Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **8:09 PM** · SPA published 8:09 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (translated); Coalition posted the conference press release at 7:53 PM (Arabic) and 8:43 PM (English, https://x.com/CJFCSpox/status/2110788783125721325); checked 8:50 PM; SPA English repeated it at 9:05 PM

SPA quoted the Coalition's official spokesman at today's press conference on the King Khalid International Airport attack as saying that targeting civilian airports is a flagrant violation of international humanitarian law and that the coalition will continue dismantling the Houthis' offensive capabilities. The Coalition also posted the conference press release in Arabic (7:53 PM) and English (8:43 PM).

CONFIRMED **Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki's "final message" to the Houthi militia: read the coalition statement carefully and between the lines**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **8:02 PM** · published 8:02 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (infographic, translated); checked 8:50 PM

Al Ekhbariya posted an infographic quoting Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki: "A final message to the terrorist Houthi militia: read the coalition statement carefully and read between the lines." No new operation was announced with it.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Houthi militia fired 16 ballistic missiles and other projectiles at residential neighborhoods in Marib, Yemen**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **8:08 PM** · published 8:08 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (breaking, translated); inside Yemen, not a strike on Saudi Arabia; checked 8:50 PM; Marib media office repeated via Al Ekhbariya at 9:15 PM

Al Ekhbariya reported, as breaking news, that the Houthi militia targeted residential neighborhoods in Marib with 16 ballistic missiles and other projectiles. No casualty figures were given in the post.

CONFIRMED **SPA: Coalition: UAV Intercepted, Destroyed in Khamis Mushait.**

SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **7:46 PM** · published 7:46 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 7:56 PM

Coalition: UAV Intercepted, Destroyed in Khamis Mushait. #SPAGOV

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone launched by the Houthi militia toward the southern region intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **7:33 PM** · published 7:33 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); also SPA @SPAregions 7:35 PM, Al Ekhbariya 7:35 PM and SPA English @Spa_Eng 8:19 PM; checked 8:50 PM

The Coalition said its forces intercepted and destroyed a drone launched by the Houthi militia toward the southern region. No casualties were reported with the statement.

CONFIRMED **Yemeni armed forces: more than 1,250 precision targeting operations against Houthi military sites in the past 24 hours (Operation Fajr al-Yemen)**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **7:39 PM** · published 7:39 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 7:56 PM

Al Ekhbariya, relaying Yemeni armed forces under Operation Fajr al-Yemen, reported more than 1,250 precision targeting operations in the past 24 hours against Houthi military sites, focusing on forward defenses, fortifications, fire sources, observation posts, command nodes, staging areas and supply lines.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over Khamis Mushait**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **6:52 PM** · published 6:52 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, translated); SPA relayed at 6:54 PM; checked 6:55 PM

The Coalition said its forces intercepted and destroyed a drone over the city of Khamis Mushait in the Asir region. No casualties or damage were reported with the statement.

CONFIRMED **Defense Minister Prince Khalid bin Salman and his Greek counterpart discuss deepening defense partnership and condemn Houthi terrorist attacks on the Kingdom**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **7:04 PM** · published 7:04 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 7:56 PM

Al Ekhbariya reported that Defense Minister Prince Khalid bin Salman and his Greek counterpart discussed strengthening the defense partnership between the two countries and condemned the terrorist attacks by the Houthi militia on the Kingdom.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense: early-warning alert in Najran at 5:57 PM, danger cleared at 5:59 PM**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:59 PM** · published 5:57 PM and 5:59 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (relaying Civil Defense, translated); Civil Defense repeated at 5:57 PM that filming or sharing intercept or impact-site information is a legal liability; checked 6:55 PM

Al Ekhbariya, relaying Saudi Civil Defense, reported an early-warning alert for Najran at 5:57 PM and that the danger had passed in Najran at 5:59 PM. No intercept or casualty report was posted with the alert.

CONFIRMED **Yemen's information minister: Houthis fired 5 missiles at the Maashiq presidential palace in Aden; prime minister and cabinet are safe**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:52 PM** · published 5:52 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (translated); Al Ekhbariya aired footage of the strike at 6:33 PM; checked 6:55 PM

Yemen's information minister said the Houthi militia targeted the Maashiq presidential palace in Aden with 5 missiles, and that the prime minister and all cabinet members are safe. The attack was in Yemen, not on Saudi territory.

CONFIRMED **Coalition demands the Houthis immediately stop all attacks on civilians and civilian sites, including airports, ports, oil facilities and infrastructure; spokesman's "final message": read the statement "between the lines"**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **5:14 PM** · published 5:14 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, translated); Al Ekhbariya relayed Al-Maliki's "final message" at 5:38 PM; checked 5:51 PM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki said the Houthis must immediately halt every terrorist operation targeting civilians and civilian objects, naming airports, ports, oil facilities and infrastructure. In what Al Ekhbariya billed as a final message, he told the Houthis to stop their attacks on civilians in the Kingdom and to read the Coalition statement carefully and between the lines.

CONFIRMED **Coalition says its "qualitative operation" answered Houthi attacks on King Khalid airport, other airports, ports, oil sites and Red Sea shipping; 127 mountain stores and many launchers destroyed in recent days**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **5:05 PM** · published 5:01–5:05 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, translated); strike footage on Al Ekhbariya 5:17–5:31 PM; checked 5:51 PM

The Coalition spokesman said Joint Forces Command carried out a qualitative operation in response to Houthi attacks on King Khalid International Airport and other airports, ports, oil facilities and commercial ships in the Red Sea, and that 127 mountain storage sites and several launch platforms were destroyed over the past few days. Al Ekhbariya aired footage it said shows strikes on ballistic-missile launchers, a missile store in Saada and tunnels and stores in Sanaa. The spokesman also presented initial investigation findings on the King Khalid airport attack (5:13 PM).

CONFIRMED **Coalition: 19 killed and 364 injured in Houthi attacks on Saudi airports, including 17 killed and 333 injured at King Khalid airport in Riyadh (20 attacks there since early October) and 2 killed, 28 injured at Abha**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **4:44 PM** · published 4:40–4:44 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (Coalition press conference, Arabic, translated); checked 5:00 PM Arab News (4:16 PM) and Al Jazeera report the same 20-attack and 17 killed, 333 injured figures for King Khalid airport (attacks of 7 to 11 Oct).

At a press conference, Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki said Houthi attacks on the Kingdom's airports have killed 19 people and injured 364: 17 killed and 333 injured at King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, which has faced 20 Houthi attacks since the start of October, and 2 killed and 28 injured at Abha airport. He put Houthi attacks on the Kingdom since operations began at 1,104 missiles and 1,135 drones.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (7044 min).

152	—	—	0	4
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
73 departures + 79 arrivals, 33% of 457 scheduled.	None on the board.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Qassim, Jeddah.

Cancellation basis: Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 6:53 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 153 at 6:54 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	73	79	152	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	73 (34%)	80 (33%)	153	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	0 (0%)	1 (0%)	1	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	62 (100%)	88 (99%)	150	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	0 of 173	0 of 190	0 of 363	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	4	4	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	7	7	14	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	227	201	428	FR24 stats panel

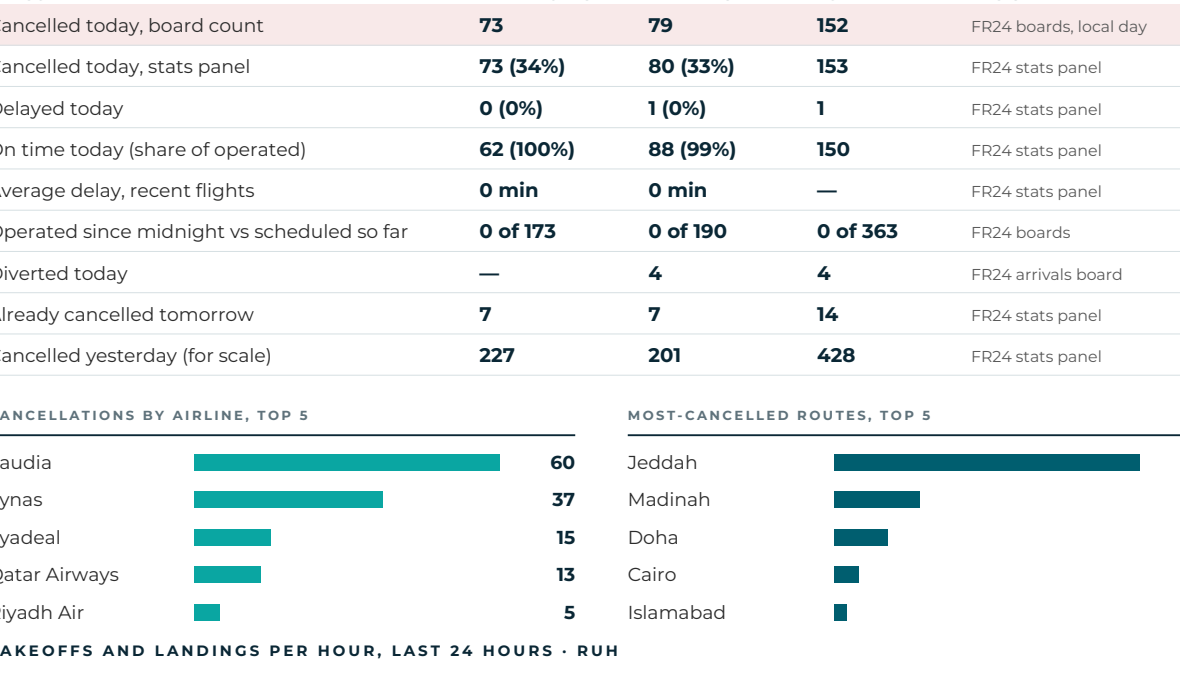
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	60
flynas	37
flyadeal	15
Qatar Airways	13
Riyadh Air	5

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	75
Madinah	21
Doha	13
Cairo	6
Islamabad	3

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



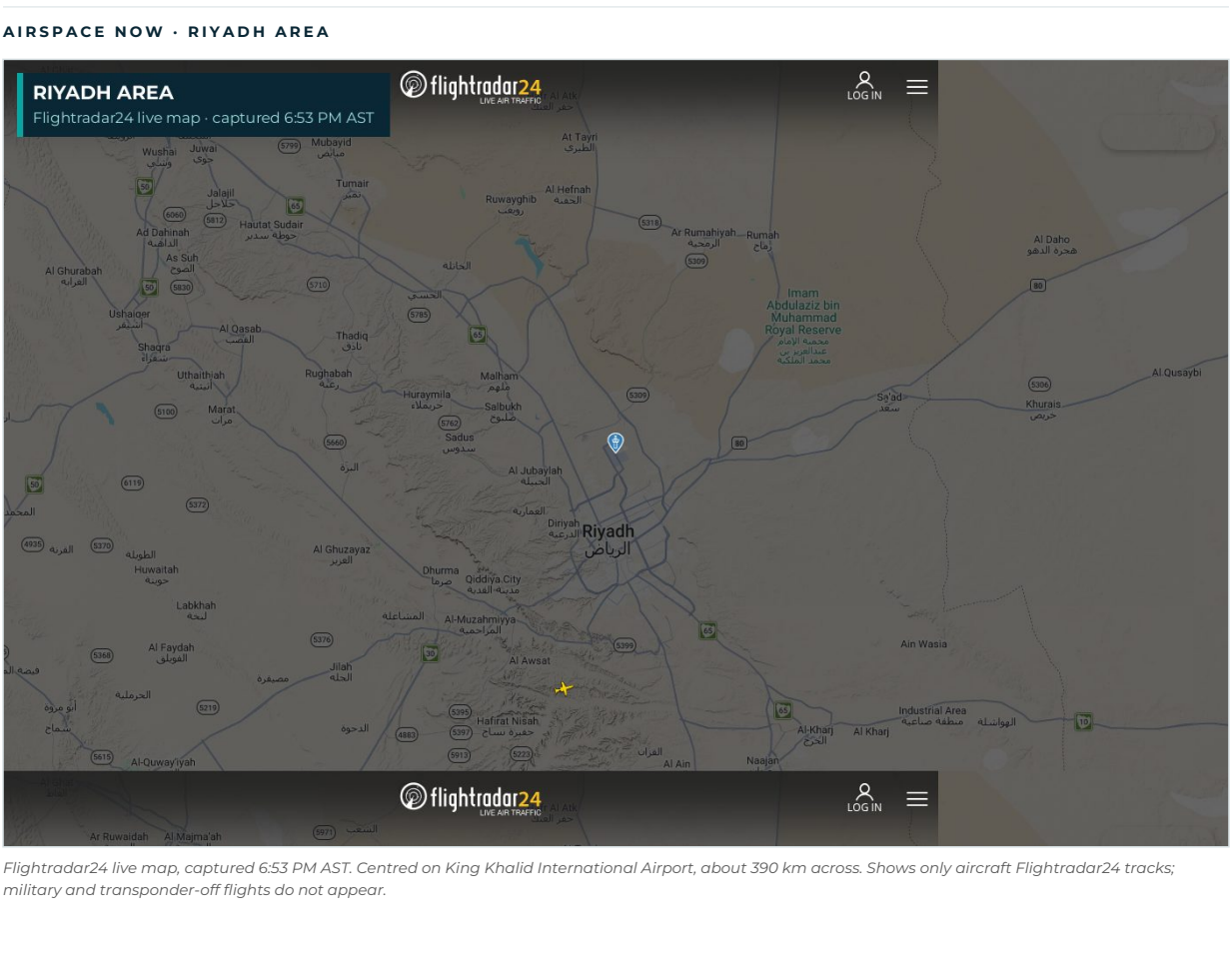
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 7:00 PM Thursday to 6:53 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam's halts in the window ran 1:04–2:42 PM, 8:58–9:56 PM, 11:40 PM–1:23 AM, 1:55–3:13 AM, 3:30–4:17 AM, 4:23–5:53 AM and 8:23–9:38 AM; traffic has moved since.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	7044 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 6:53 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5 Dammam airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 5:44 PM (69 min).

60	5:25 PM	5:44 PM	0	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
28 departures + 32 arrivals, 26% of 231 scheduled.	PK246 to Islamabad, 88 min before 6:53 PM.	XY420 from Jeddah, 69 min before 6:53 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

Cancellation basis: Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 6:53 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 60 at 6:54 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	28	32	60	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	28 (24%)	32 (27%)	60	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	22 (19%)	19 (16%)	41	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	19 (46%)	25 (57%)	44	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	36 of 83	34 of 86	70 of 169	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	7	8	15	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	50	48	98	FR24 stats panel

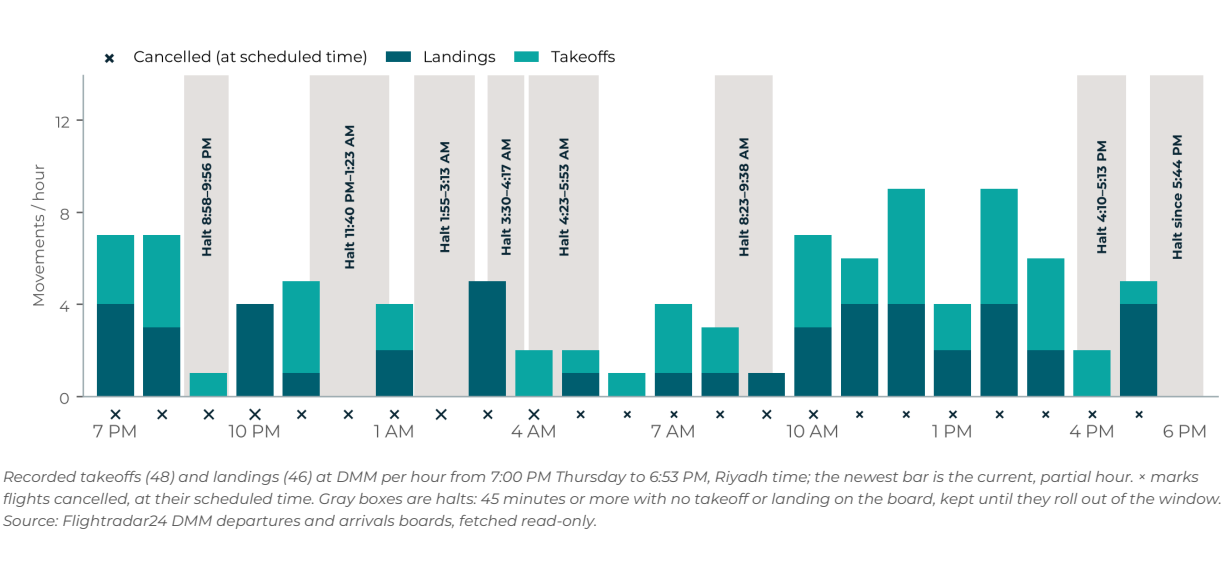
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Egyptair	8
Etihad Airways	8
Emirates	6
Air Arabia	6
Qatar Airways	6

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Abu Dhabi	8
Jeddah	7
Cairo	6
Dubai	6
Sharjah	6

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (48) and landings (46) at DMM per hour from 7:00 PM Thursday to 6:53 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Open halt since 5:44 PM; 0 takeoffs and 0 landings in the last hour.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

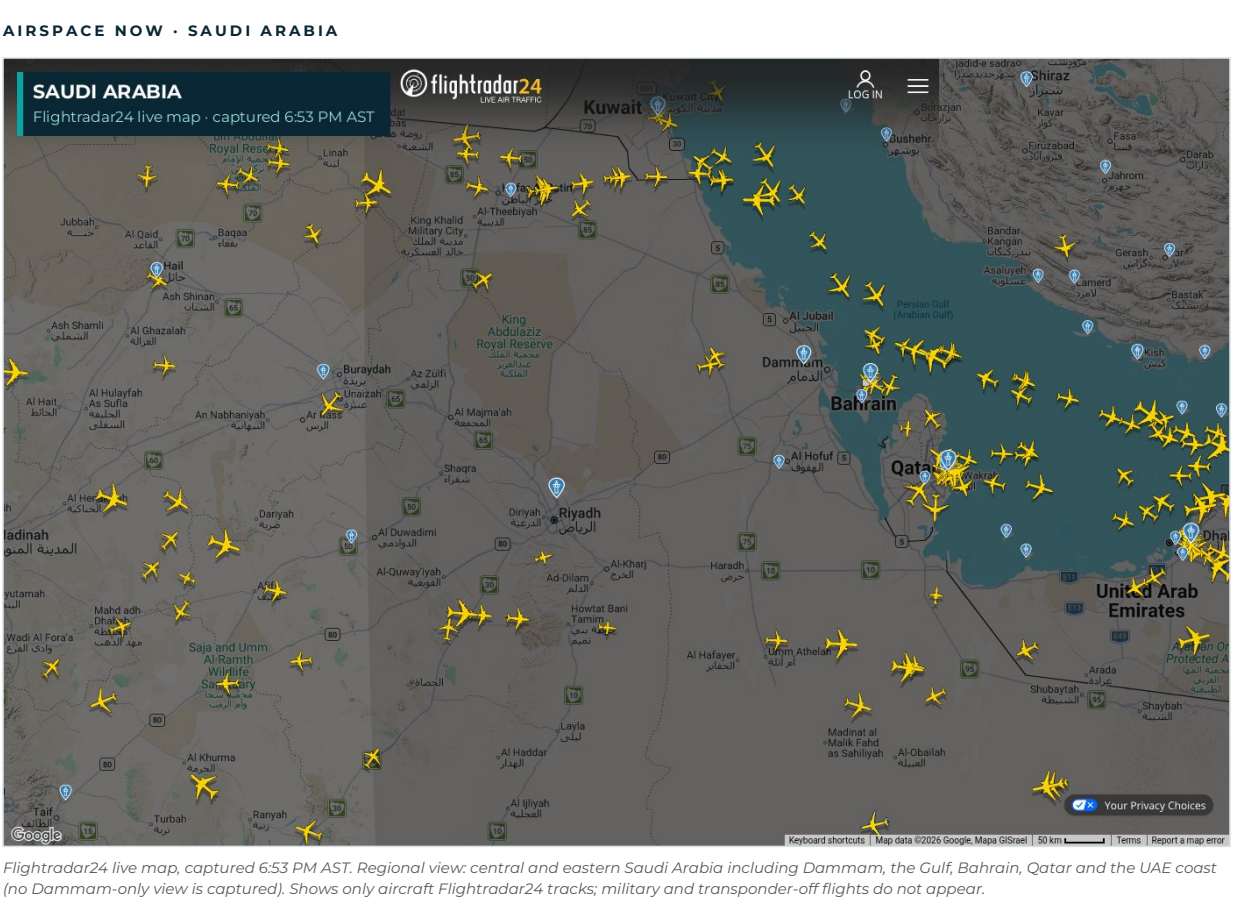
OPEN Halt since 5:44 PM	69 min and counting
Halt 4:10–5:13 PM	63 min
Halt 8:23–9:38 AM	75 min
Halt 4:23–5:53 AM	91 min
Halt 3:30–4:17 AM	47 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

UNVERIFIED **Social posts claim explosions in Dammam and a fresh halt at King Fahd airport** (Raaz News; other social accounts · 9:46 AM)

UNVERIFIED **Sprinter Press posts that air traffic is suspended at Dammam airport** (Sprinter Press (@SprinterPress) · 7:40 AM)

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



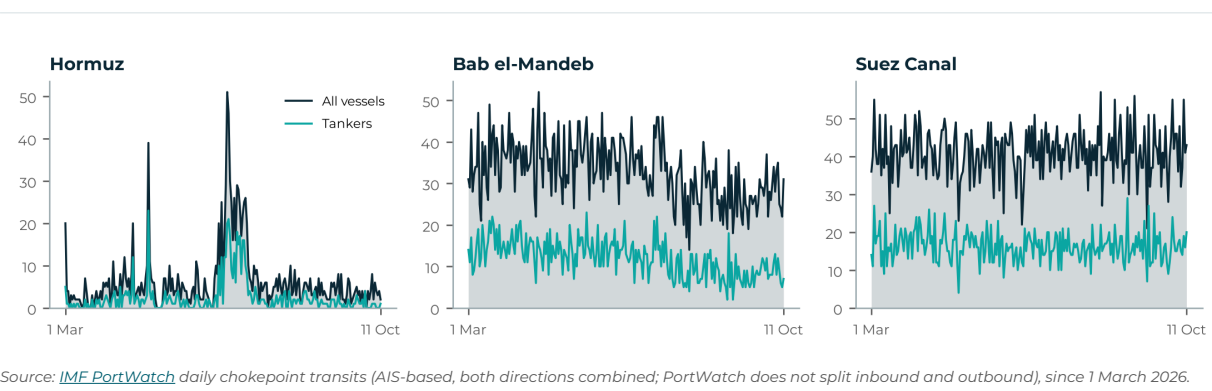
Flightradar24 live map, captured 6:53 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

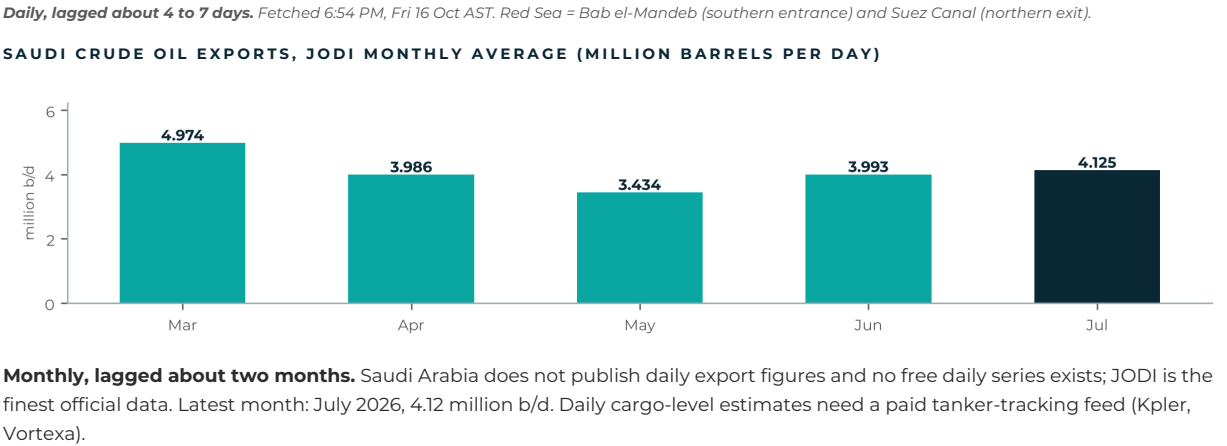
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 6:54 PM, Fri 16 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

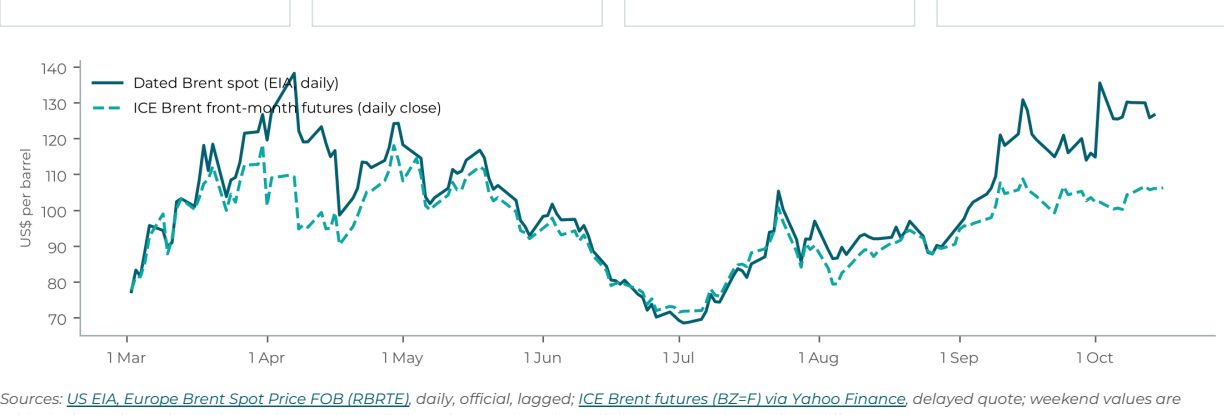


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$106.25	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 6:44 PM, Fri 16 Oct AST (+0.3% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 6:53 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
6:53 PM, Fri 16 Oct	6:53 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Halted**	Open sources · not official	8:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 8:00 PM